

The card kit

The same tools, laid out on a table. Printed cards hold the categories and the questions. What you find goes on yellow evidence cards or sticky notes.

WHAT'S INSIDE

	Evidence · anything you saw, heard or found. Every tool.	S1
	Channel · where a quote came from. Tool 1.	S2
	Question · answer it on a teal note. Several tools.	S2 S3 S5
	People · roles around the product. Tools 2 and 4.	S3
	Need, four suits · people, objects, systems, information. Tool 3.	S4
	Failure + blame tokens · what goes wrong at a step, and where the blame lands. Tool 3.	S5
	Constraint · the one hard limit you give your persona. Tool 3.	S6
	Lens + Finding · three ways to read power, and findings to rate. Tool 4.	S7
	Synthesis · one line per tool, three redesigns, the claim.	S8

PRINT THE CARDS

Sheets S1–S8 (p.113–1.20) on A4 card, 250–300 gsm. Cut along the dashed lines. Print S1 five times and S4 twice. The rest once.

PRINT THE BOARDS

Boards B1–B7 (p.1.21–1.27) at A2, landscape. A3 works for pairs. No big printer? Copy the board onto chart paper.

SET UP THE TABLE

- 1 Put one board in the middle. Only the one for the tool you're doing.
- 2 Sort the cards face up by colour, along the edge of the table.
- 3 Keep sticky notes and pens out. You still write on notes.
- 4 Photograph the board before you clear it. The photo is your record.

A card is a prompt, not evidence. Everything you put on a board has to come from something real you saw, heard or found.

Evidence cards

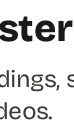
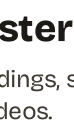
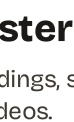
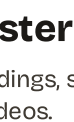
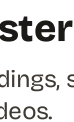
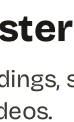
PRINT ×5 ON CARD

Cut along the dashed lines

EVIDENCES1 What I saw or heard WHERE · CHANNEL WHO DATE TOOL SEEN HEARD ONLINE	EVIDENCES1 What I saw or heard WHERE · CHANNEL WHO DATE TOOL SEEN HEARD ONLINE	EVIDENCES1 What I saw or heard WHERE · CHANNEL WHO DATE TOOL SEEN HEARD ONLINE
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Channel + question cards

Cut along the dashed lines

CHANNEL	TOOL 1 · S2	CHANNEL	TOOL 1 · S2	CHANNEL	TOOL 1 · S2
Ad or poster TV, print, hoardings, social media ads, launch videos.  Lay it in circle ① Media story PUT THE QUOTES YOU FIND FROM THIS CHANNEL NEXT TO IT. NOTE THE CHANNEL ON EACH.		Official page App store listing, website, scheme notice, press release.  Lay it in circle ① Media story PUT THE QUOTES YOU FIND FROM THIS CHANNEL NEXT TO IT. NOTE THE CHANNEL ON EACH.		FAQ or support reply Help pages, replies to complaints, emails from the helpdesk.  Lay it in circle ② Official feedback PUT THE QUOTES YOU FIND FROM THIS CHANNEL NEXT TO IT. NOTE THE CHANNEL ON EACH.	
Public review App store and Google reviews, where the company can reply.  Lay it in circle ② Official feedback PUT THE QUOTES YOU FIND FROM THIS CHANNEL NEXT TO IT. NOTE THE CHANNEL ON EACH.		Forum or comments Reddit, Quora, YouTube comments, Facebook groups.  Lay it in circle ③ Gossip PUT THE QUOTES YOU FIND FROM THIS CHANNEL NEXT TO IT. NOTE THE CHANNEL ON EACH.		Chat or word of mouth Forwards, what seniors say, what people told you in interviews.  Lay it in circle ③ Gossip PUT THE QUOTES YOU FIND FROM THIS CHANNEL NEXT TO IT. NOTE THE CHANNEL ON EACH.	
QUESTION	TOOL 1 · S2	QUESTION	TOOL 1 · S2	QUESTION	TOOL 1 · S2
GOSSIP ONLY Why can't this be said officially? ANSWER ON A TEAL NOTE. PLACE IT NEXT TO THIS CARD.		THE CENTRE · ALL THREE Why hasn't it been fixed? Who gains? ANSWER ON A TEAL NOTE. PLACE IT NEXT TO THIS CARD.		FOLK FIXES What workaround do seniors pass on? ANSWER ON A TEAL NOTE. PLACE IT NEXT TO THIS CARD.	

People + question cards

Cut along the dashed lines

PEOPLE TOOLS 2 + 4 · S3  An official or clerk Checked the papers. Could sometimes make an exception. WHO, EXACTLY _____ TOOL 2 · HISTORY ☐ Then ☐ Now ☐ Lost a role ☐ Gained one TOOL 4 · UNPAID HELPER ☐ Paid by it ☐ Credited ☐ Needed	PEOPLE TOOLS 2 + 4 · S3  A teacher or principal Signed, verified, reminded, chased. WHO, EXACTLY _____ TOOL 2 · HISTORY ☐ Then ☐ Now ☐ Lost a role ☐ Gained one TOOL 4 · UNPAID HELPER ☐ Paid by it ☐ Credited ☐ Needed	PEOPLE TOOLS 2 + 4 · S3  A family member Parent, sibling, spouse. Holds a phone, a document or the money. WHO, EXACTLY _____ TOOL 2 · HISTORY ☐ Then ☐ Now ☐ Lost a role ☐ Gained one TOOL 4 · UNPAID HELPER ☐ Paid by it ☐ Credited ☐ Needed
PEOPLE TOOLS 2 + 4 · S3  A local shop Cybercafé, photocopy or recharge shop. Paid by the user. WHO, EXACTLY _____ TOOL 2 · HISTORY ☐ Then ☐ Now ☐ Lost a role ☐ Gained one TOOL 4 · UNPAID HELPER ☐ Paid by it ☐ Credited ☐ Needed	PEOPLE TOOLS 2 + 4 · S3  An agent or middleman Fills forms or “fixes” problems for a fee. WHO, EXACTLY _____ TOOL 2 · HISTORY ☐ Then ☐ Now ☐ Lost a role ☐ Gained one TOOL 4 · UNPAID HELPER ☐ Paid by it ☐ Credited ☐ Needed	PEOPLE TOOLS 2 + 4 · S3  A friend or senior Passes on how it's really done. WHO, EXACTLY _____ TOOL 2 · HISTORY ☐ Then ☐ Now ☐ Lost a role ☐ Gained one TOOL 4 · UNPAID HELPER ☐ Paid by it ☐ Credited ☐ Needed
PEOPLE TOOLS 2 + 4 · S3  Someone else Write the role. WHO, EXACTLY _____ TOOL 2 · HISTORY ☐ Then ☐ Now ☐ Lost a role ☐ Gained one TOOL 4 · UNPAID HELPER ☐ Paid by it ☐ Credited ☐ Needed	QUESTION TOOL 2 · S3 TOOL 2 · HISTORY What did it remove that people used to be able to do? _____ _____ _____ ANSWER ON A TEAL NOTE. PLACE IT NEXT TO THIS CARD.	QUESTION TOOL 2 · S3 TOOL 2 · HISTORY Which power stayed the same, in a new form? _____ _____ _____ ANSWER ON A TEAL NOTE. PLACE IT NEXT TO THIS CARD.

Need cards · four suits

PEOPLE S4 WHO MUST HELP? STEP __ ☐ LEFT TO USER	PEOPLE S4 WHO MUST HELP? STEP __ ☐ LEFT TO USER	PEOPLE S4 WHO MUST HELP? STEP __ ☐ LEFT TO USER	PEOPLE S4 WHO MUST HELP? STEP __ ☐ LEFT TO USER
PEOPLE S4 WHO MUST HELP? STEP __ ☐ LEFT TO USER	OBJECTS S4 WHAT MUST THEY OWN? STEP __ ☐ LEFT TO USER	OBJECTS S4 WHAT MUST THEY OWN? STEP __ ☐ LEFT TO USER	OBJECTS S4 WHAT MUST THEY OWN? STEP __ ☐ LEFT TO USER
OBJECTS S4 WHAT MUST THEY OWN? STEP __ ☐ LEFT TO USER	OBJECTS S4 WHAT MUST THEY OWN? STEP __ ☐ LEFT TO USER	SYSTEMS S4 WHAT ELSE MUST WORK? STEP __ ☐ LEFT TO USER	SYSTEMS S4 WHAT ELSE MUST WORK? STEP __ ☐ LEFT TO USER
SYSTEMS S4 WHAT ELSE MUST WORK? STEP __ ☐ LEFT TO USER	SYSTEMS S4 WHAT ELSE MUST WORK? STEP __ ☐ LEFT TO USER	SYSTEMS S4 WHAT ELSE MUST WORK? STEP __ ☐ LEFT TO USER	INFORMATION S4 WHAT MUST THEY KNOW? STEP __ ☐ LEFT TO USER
INFORMATION S4 WHAT MUST THEY KNOW? STEP __ ☐ LEFT TO USER	INFORMATION S4 WHAT MUST THEY KNOW? STEP __ ☐ LEFT TO USER	INFORMATION S4 WHAT MUST THEY KNOW? STEP __ ☐ LEFT TO USER	INFORMATION S4 WHAT MUST THEY KNOW? STEP __ ☐ LEFT TO USER

Failure cards, blame tokens, questions

FAILURETOOL 3 • S5 System failure Something in the Systems row doesn't work: the server, the SMS, the match. Look at the Systems row on your flow. STEP _____ LIKELY _____ /10 AT EACH STEP, DRAW THE LIKELIEST FAILURE	FAILURETOOL 3 • S5 Person unavailable Someone from the People row isn't there when they're needed. Look at the People row on your flow. STEP _____ LIKELY _____ /10 AT EACH STEP, DRAW THE LIKELIEST FAILURE	FAILURETOOL 3 • S5 Object missing Something from the Objects row isn't at hand, or doesn't work. Look at the Objects row on your flow. STEP _____ LIKELY _____ /10 AT EACH STEP, DRAW THE LIKELIEST FAILURE
FAILURETOOL 3 • S5 Information gap They don't know it, and the product doesn't say. Look at the Information row on your flow. STEP _____ LIKELY _____ /10 AT EACH STEP, DRAW THE LIKELIEST FAILURE	FAILURETOOL 3 • S5 No time Everything is there, except the time the step demands. Look at the All rows rows on your flow. STEP _____ LIKELY _____ /10 AT EACH STEP, DRAW THE LIKELIEST FAILURE	FAILURETOOL 3 • S5 Another failure Something that breaks, but isn't on the other cards. _____ _____ _____ STEP _____ LIKELY _____ /10 AT EACH STEP, DRAW THE LIKELIEST FAILURE
BLAME TOKENSTOOL 3 • S5 1 Where the user puts the blame 2 Where the product's words put it ★ Where it belongs CUT OUT THE THREE ROUND TOKENS	QUESTIONTOOL 3 • S5 VILLAIN STORY Does the person know they're the exception? _____ _____ _____ ANSWER ON A TEAL NOTE. PLACE IT NEXT TO THIS CARD.	QUESTIONTOOL 3 • S5 VILLAIN STORY Is the workaround dignified? _____ _____ _____ ANSWER ON A TEAL NOTE. PLACE IT NEXT TO THIS CARD.

Constraint cards · for your villain persona

Cut along the dashed lines

CONSTRAINT TOOL 3 · S6 Shared phone The phone belongs to someone else in the family. So do the OTPs. GIVE YOUR PERSONA ONE. ONLY ONE.	CONSTRAINT TOOL 3 · S6 Only a phone camera No scanner, no printer, no laptop. GIVE YOUR PERSONA ONE. ONLY ONE.	CONSTRAINT TOOL 3 · S6 Patchy network Signal comes and goes. The data pack runs out mid-month. GIVE YOUR PERSONA ONE. ONLY ONE.
CONSTRAINT TOOL 3 · S6 A different language Comfortable in a language the product doesn't use. GIVE YOUR PERSONA ONE. ONLY ONE.	CONSTRAINT TOOL 3 · S6 No free time Works or studies long hours. Free only late at night. GIVE YOUR PERSONA ONE. ONLY ONE.	CONSTRAINT TOOL 3 · S6 A missing document One paper is lost, expired, or in a slightly different name. GIVE YOUR PERSONA ONE. ONLY ONE.
CONSTRAINT TOOL 3 · S6 Needs permission Someone else has to agree before they can act. GIVE YOUR PERSONA ONE. ONLY ONE.	CONSTRAINT TOOL 3 · S6 The deadline is close One try left before it closes. GIVE YOUR PERSONA ONE. ONLY ONE.	CONSTRAINT TOOL 3 · S6 Your own A hard limit you saw in the field. GIVE YOUR PERSONA ONE. ONLY ONE.

Lens + finding cards

Cut along the dashed lines

LENS TOOL 4 · S7 Creator lens 1 Who built it? 2 Were they rushing, saving money or ticking boxes? 3 Find three moments where it shows. ANSWERS ON TEAL NOTES, BESIDE THIS CARD	LENS TOOL 4 · S7 Authority lens 1 Where is the most friction? 2 Whom does it protect? 3 How many steps to reach a human? Whose name is in the error? ANSWERS ON TEAL NOTES, BESIDE THIS CARD	LENS TOOL 4 · S7 Political lens 1 More independent, or more dependent? 2 What must users hand over? Where does it go? 3 What would it have to stop doing? ANSWERS ON TEAL NOTES, BESIDE THIS CARD
FINDING TOOL 4 · S7 Finding PLACE IT UNDER MINOR, MAJOR OR CRITICAL	FINDING TOOL 4 · S7 Finding PLACE IT UNDER MINOR, MAJOR OR CRITICAL	FINDING TOOL 4 · S7 Finding PLACE IT UNDER MINOR, MAJOR OR CRITICAL
FINDING TOOL 4 · S7 Finding PLACE IT UNDER MINOR, MAJOR OR CRITICAL	FINDING TOOL 4 · S7 Finding PLACE IT UNDER MINOR, MAJOR OR CRITICAL	FINDING TOOL 4 · S7 Finding PLACE IT UNDER MINOR, MAJOR OR CRITICAL

Synthesis cards

PRINT ×1 ON CARD

Cut along the dashed lines

SYNTHESIS S8 ONE LINE FROM Media POINTS TO CARD EVERY LINE MUST POINT TO A CARD	SYNTHESIS S8 ONE LINE FROM Gossip POINTS TO CARD EVERY LINE MUST POINT TO A CARD	SYNTHESIS S8 ONE LINE FROM History POINTS TO CARD EVERY LINE MUST POINT TO A CARD
SYNTHESIS S8 ONE LINE FROM Power POINTS TO CARD EVERY LINE MUST POINT TO A CARD	SYNTHESIS S8 ONE LINE FROM Villain ★ POINTS TO CARD EVERY LINE MUST POINT TO A CARD	REDESIGN S8 A REDESIGN A SPECIFIC SCREEN OR STEP GAINS RESISTS PLACE IT ON THE BLAME SCALE, BOARD B7
REDESIGN S8 B REDESIGN A SPECIFIC SCREEN OR STEP GAINS RESISTS PLACE IT ON THE BLAME SCALE, BOARD B7	REDESIGN S8 C REDESIGN A SPECIFIC SCREEN OR STEP GAINS RESISTS PLACE IT ON THE BLAME SCALE, BOARD B7	CLAIM S8 The design claim We should redesign _____ , because it would shift blame from _____ to _____ , and would specifically help _____ . EVERY BLANK MUST POINT TO A CARD

The Media Story

The person in the ads

AGE _____ PLACE _____

DEVICE _____ MOOD _____

STICK A SCREENSHOT OF THE AD

Your real user

AGE _____ PLACE _____

DEVICE _____ MOOD _____

STICK A PHOTO OR SKETCH, WITH CONSENT

PRODUCT _____

- 1 Spend 15 minutes with real ads and notices.
- 2 Fill both people. Then A–D on yellow cards, numbered by prompt.

PRINT A2 LANDSCAPE · A3 FOR PAIRS
Cards: S1 Evidence

A What it claims

- 1 Its main promise, in its own words
- 2 A word the ads keep using that the product doesn't live up to
- 3 How a user would describe it to a friend

B The story it sells

- 1 Where the ads' story starts
- 2 Where it ends
- 3 What it skips

C What the designers meant

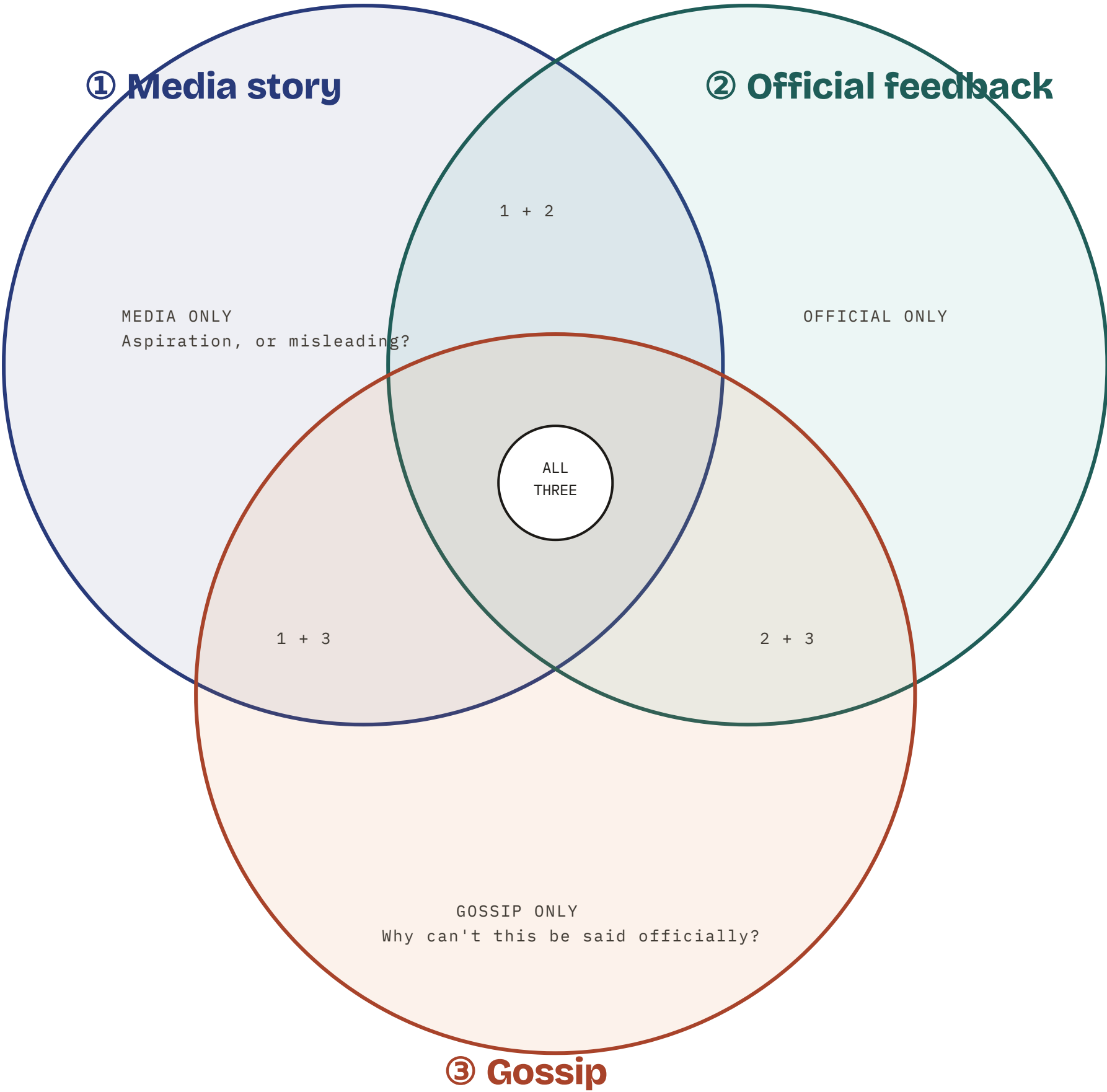
- 1 The problem the designers set out to solve, in their own words
- 2 The user they imagined
- 3 What they designed against, and its cost

D How users experience it

- 1 First time (signing up)
- 2 Using it (the main task)
- 3 Afterwards (waiting, coming back)

The Gossip Venn

PRINT A2 LANDSCAPE · A3 FOR PAIRS
Cards: S1 Evidence · S2 Channels + questions



ASK OF EACH ZONE

Centre. Why hasn't it been fixed? Who gains?

Tone. Which words vanish in official channels?

Folk fixes. What workaround do seniors pass on?

★ HARDEST CONTRADICTION · KEEP FOR SYNTHESIS

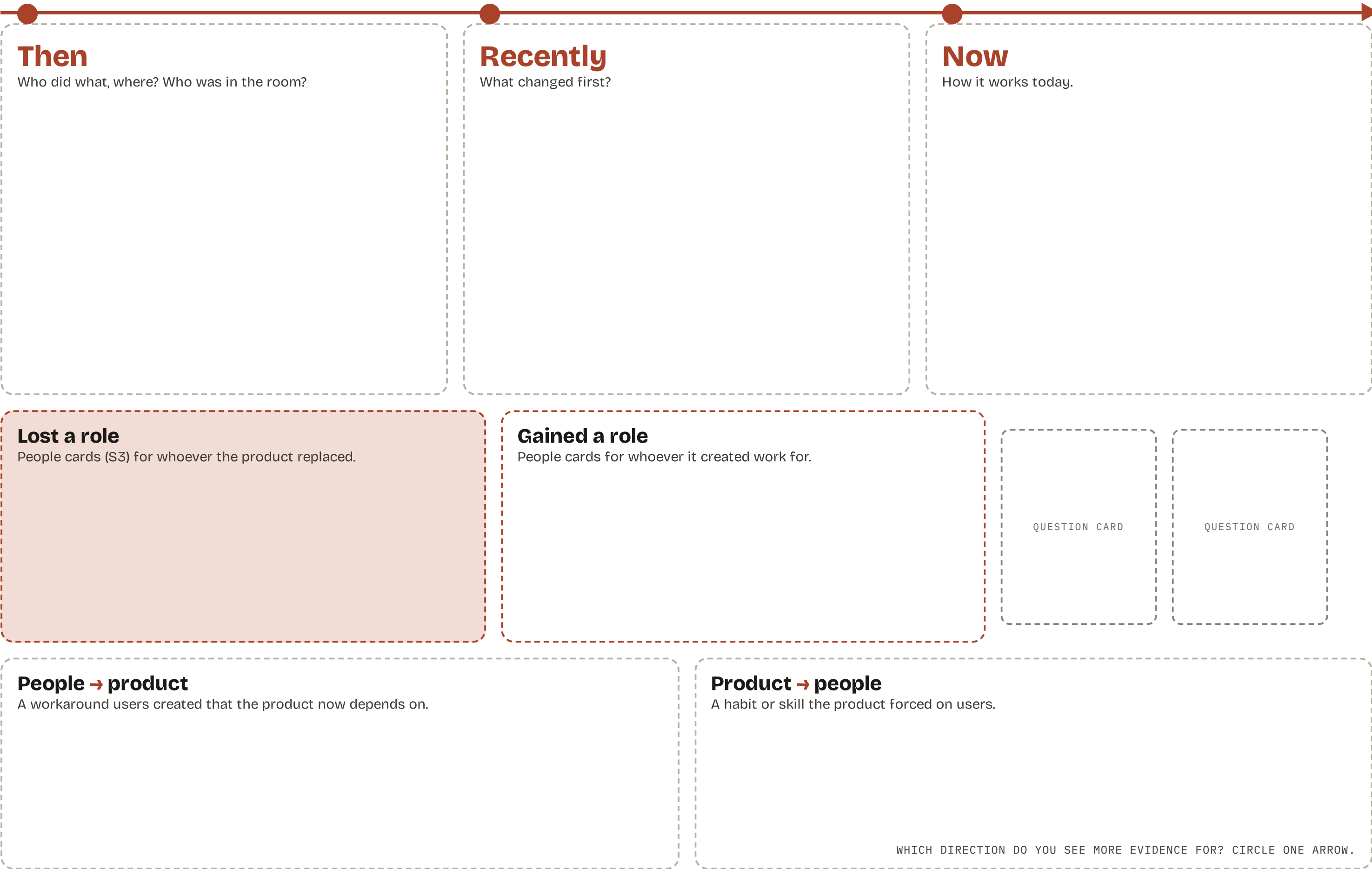
Which two circles clash most?

- 1 Channel cards (S2) go in their circles.
- 2 Quotes on yellow cards, next to their channel.
- 3 Overlaps matter most. Move cards as you argue.
- 4 Question cards: answer on teal notes.

The timeline

- 1
- Talk to someone who did it before it went digital.
- 2
- Notes on the timeline. Move People cards to lost or gained.
- 3
- Put each change on its arrow. Answer the question cards.

PRINT A2 LANDSCAPE · A3 FOR PAIRS
Cards: S1 Evidence · S3 People + questions



Ideal flow + needs

FEATURE _____ GOAL _____

- 1 Steps on orange notes. Then need cards (S4) under each step.
- 2 Fill the dot on every need left for the user to solve.

PRINT A2 LANDSCAPE · A3 FOR PAIRS
Cards: S4 Need cards

	STEP 1	STEP 2	STEP 3	STEP 4	STEP 5	STEP 6
PEOPLE Who must help?						
OBJECTS What must they own?						
SYSTEMS What else must work?						
INFORMATION What must they know?						
WHO THIS WAS DESIGNED FOR · DEVICE, TIME, SKILLS, WHO THEY CAN CALL						
☐ Left to the user: ____ of ____ needs						

Villain walk + Blame Scale

PRINT A2 LANDSCAPE · A3 FOR PAIRS
Cards: S5 Failure, tokens · S6 Constraints

The villain persona

Very unlike the ideal user.

NAME _____

CONTEXT _____

CONSTRAINT CARD ·
S6

- 1 Draw one constraint card for the persona.
- 2 Walk them through each step. Draw the likeliest failure card.
- 3 Write what broke and who pays. Star the likeliest break.
- 4 Take the starred step to the Blame Scale.

QUESTION CARD

QUESTION CARD

STEP _____



FAILURE CARD

WHAT BROKE · WORKAROUND

LIKELY _____ /10

WHO PAYS _____

STEP _____



FAILURE CARD

WHAT BROKE · WORKAROUND

LIKELY _____ /10

WHO PAYS _____

STEP _____



FAILURE CARD

WHAT BROKE · WORKAROUND

LIKELY _____ /10

WHO PAYS _____

STEP _____



FAILURE CARD

WHAT BROKE · WORKAROUND

LIKELY _____ /10

WHO PAYS _____

STEP _____



FAILURE CARD

WHAT BROKE · WORKAROUND

LIKELY _____ /10

WHO PAYS _____

The Blame Scale

Place tokens 1, 2 and ★ (S5) on the line.

STEP _____

Self · “my fault”

System · “its fault”

The gap is the distance between what this product _____ and what it should have _____.

Three lenses + findings

- 1
- Choose: this product live, or 2–3 similar ones.
- 2
- Read it through each lens card. Answers on teal notes.
- 3
- Rate every finding by where you put it.

PRINT A2 LANDSCAPE · A3 FOR PAIRS
Cards: S3 People · S7 Lens + findings

CREATOR LENS CARD

Creator
Who built it, and what did they rush?

AUTHORITY LENS CARD

Authority
What is the institution really guarding against?

POLITICAL LENS CARD

Political
More independent, or more dependent?

Unpaid helpers
Who does work to make it function, without being paid or credited by it? People cards (S3).

PEOPLE CARD

PEOPLE CARD

PEOPLE CARD

PEOPLE CARD

PEOPLE CARD

PEOPLE CARD

Findings

Each finding: a quote or observation

MINOR

MAJOR

CRITICAL

COMPONENT 1 · CARD KIT · BOARD B6

1.26

Synthesis

PRINT A2 LANDSCAPE · A3 FOR PAIRS
Cards: S8 Synthesis · all cards from Tools 1–4

1 · ONE LINE FROM EACH TOOL

MEDIA

GOSSIP

HISTORY

POWER

VILLAIN ★

2 · THE SHARPEST CONTRADICTION

“The product claims _____
, but _____ revealed
_____.”

3 + 4 · THREE REDESIGNS ON THE BLAME SCALE

Place cards A, B, C (S8) on the line. Which one moves the blame furthest toward the system?



5 · POWER TEST

“If this were built, _____ would gain
_____. And _____ would resist it
because _____.”

6 · THE FINDING

“This product assumes _____, but the user
actually has _____, which causes _____
.”

CLAIM CARD

7 · THE DESIGN CLAIM

Fill the claim card last. Every blank must
point to a card already on this board.